

MISSION REBUILD™ — Course Positioning Document

Internal Strategy Reference | Creator Use Only

Course Title and Subtitle

Primary Title: MISSION REBUILD™

Full Title: MISSION REBUILD™: From Army to Civilian — Building Structure, Purpose, Identity & Financial Stability After Service

Working Tagline Options:

- *"The transition plan the Army should have given you."*
- *"Built by a veteran who crashed and rebuilt. So you don't have to."*
- *"Stop surviving the transition. Start owning what comes next."*
- *"Your DD-214 was an ending. This is the beginning."*

Recommended Primary Tagline: *"The transition plan the Army should have given you."*

This works because it acknowledges the institutional failure without being whiny, positions the course as the corrective, and doesn't require the prospect to admit weakness — it assigns the failure to the system, not to them, which lowers the barrier to purchase.

Target Audience

Primary Audiences (In Priority Order)

1. The Enlisted Veteran, 1–3 Years Out (Highest Purchase Intent)

- Rank at separation: E4–E7 (Specialist/Corporal through Sergeant First Class)
- Age range: 24–34
- Time since separation: 12–36 months

- Situation: Working a job that doesn't feel like enough, drinking more than they planned to, relationship struggling, gym attendance inconsistent, savings thin, VA benefits underutilized or unexplored, identity still tied to their unit and their rank
- Trigger for purchase: A moment of honest reckoning — a job rejection, a fight with their partner, a night alone where they're being straight with themselves about how far off track things have gotten
- What they tell themselves: "I'm fine, I'm just adjusting."
- What they actually feel: Lost, disconnected, secretly scared they peaked in the Army

2. The Approaching ETS Soldier (Urgency-Driven Buyer)

- 60–180 days from separation
- Rank: E4–E6, some junior officers (O1–O3 leaving after first or second commitment)
- Wants a plan before they need one
- The "smart" buyer — they're proactive enough to look for a solution before the crisis hits
- Will respond to: "Get ahead of this" messaging, the contrast of prepared vs. unprepared, statistics about veteran transition struggles
- Fear driver: Watching someone else's transition go badly

3. The Senior NCO or Officer Who Expected Better (Pain-Driven Buyer)

- Rank at separation: E7–E9 or O3–O5
- Age range: 35–48
- Problem: They had authority, deference, and identity baked into their rank. Civilian world doesn't care about their rank. The psychological drop is severe.
- They're often more financially stable but more emotionally adrift
- Will respond to: Language about leadership identity, relevance, and rebuilding influence
- Messaging note: Don't make them feel small. Acknowledge what they had. Focus on translation and reinvention, not starting over.

4. The Veteran 3–5 Years Out Who Is Finally Ready to Deal With It

- Has been white-knuckling it for years
- Something cracked — divorce, DUI, job loss, health scare, a conversation with another veteran
- This buyer is the most emotionally raw and the most motivated
- They need to feel seen more than anyone else in the funnel
- Will respond to: Specific, accurate descriptions of their internal experience that make them feel understood before asking them to buy anything

Secondary Audiences

- Spouses and family members of transitioning veterans (gifting the course, or doing it alongside the vet)

- Veteran service organization (VSO) case managers looking for structured curriculum to recommend to clients
 - Military to civilian transition coaches looking for curriculum to license
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Pain Points — Specific and Unfiltered

These are the actual problems the course solves. Knowing them precisely allows for accurate, resonant marketing that feels like it was written by someone who knows the prospect — because it was.

1. Identity Loss

The uniform wasn't just clothing. It was a role, a tribe, a purpose, a schedule, and a value system. When it comes off, there's no civilian equivalent that fills the space. Veterans report feeling invisible, irrelevant, and undefined. The civilian world doesn't provide the identity scaffolding the military did, and nobody warns you about the gap.

2. Structural Collapse

The military told you where to be, when to be there, what to wear, what your objectives were, and who was counting on you. Civilian life hands you an open calendar and says "figure it out." For people trained to operate within structure, the freedom feels less like liberation and more like floating in open water with no horizon in sight.

3. Isolation

Military friendships are forged under pressure and sustained by proximity. When you separate, you lose both the people and the environment. Civilian coworkers and neighbors don't share your reference points. Veterans describe feeling profoundly alone in rooms full of people. The isolation is real, it's underdiagnosed, and it compounds every other problem on this list.

4. Financial Confusion and Anxiety

Most junior enlisted veterans weren't paid enough to build savings, weren't taught financial strategy, and separated without a real understanding of their VA benefits, the GI Bill, housing stipends, disability rating processes, or investment basics. They're starting civilian financial life from scratch, often with thin margins and little financial literacy.

5. Career Identity Confusion

Veterans have real, significant skills — leadership, logistics, operations, pressure management, technical specialties — but they were never taught to translate those skills into civilian language. They walk into job interviews sounding like they're briefing an AAR, use military acronyms nobody recognizes, undersell their leadership experience because they don't know how to frame it, and end up in jobs that underutilize them and underwhelm them.

6. The Civilian Imposter Syndrome

Veterans often don't feel like they belong in civilian environments. They feel like they're performing "civilian" rather than being it. They laugh at the wrong things, care about the wrong things, can't connect over office politics or weekend small talk. The harder they try to fit in, the more foreign it feels.

7. Alcohol and Substance Use as Coping Mechanisms

This one doesn't get said in polite veteran transition spaces. It should. Alcohol is deeply normalized in military culture and it becomes a management tool for the anxiety, boredom, sleeplessness, and emotional flatness of transition. For many veterans, the use escalates without ever crossing a dramatic line — it's functional, consistent, and quietly corrosive.

8. Relationship Strain and Communication Breakdown

The communication patterns that work in the Army — direct, mission-focused, unemotional, hierarchical — are almost perfectly calibrated to damage intimate relationships. Veterans return home emotionally compressed, conflict-hardened, and often unaware of how they're landing with their partners and kids. The relationship damage accumulates. Divorce rates in the veteran population are not an accident.

9. Mental Flatness and Loss of Adrenaline

Combat veterans and high-intensity operators often experience civilian life as profoundly under-stimulating. The low-grade flatness, the absence of stakes, the meaninglessness of most civilian urgency — all of it reads as emptiness. This isn't always PTSD. Sometimes it's just the absence of the intensity that made them feel alive. It becomes a driver of risk-seeking, substance use, and purposelessness.

10. The Slow Drift

Many veterans don't have a dramatic crash. They have a slow drift. Each year they get a little further from the person they wanted to be when they got out. The dreams get smaller. The plans get vaguer. The comfort zone gets more comfortable. By year three, they're settled into a life that technically works and fundamentally doesn't. The slow drift is the most common veteran transition failure mode and the hardest one to talk about because there's nothing specific to point to.

Transformation Promise

Before MISSION REBUILD™

- Identity is tied to rank, unit, and service — and that foundation is gone
- No daily structure means no momentum
- Financial situation is unclear, VA benefits are unexplored or misunderstood
- Career path feels random or insufficient
- Alcohol is more present than it should be
- Relationship is strained by communication patterns carried over from service
- Isolation is building quietly in the background
- No 5-year plan — or a vague one nobody actually believes

After MISSION REBUILD™

- Identity is rebuilt on values, capabilities, and chosen purpose — not on rank
 - A daily personal operating system is designed and running
 - VA benefits are understood and maximized; a real financial plan exists
 - Career path is chosen deliberately, with translated skills and clear next steps
 - Relationship with alcohol and stress has been examined and actively managed
 - Communication with partners and family has improved in specific, practiced ways
 - Community of veterans at the same stage of life has been found and used
 - A written 5-year mission plan exists — specific, believable, and personally authored
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Unique Selling Proposition

What Makes MISSION REBUILD™ Different From Every Other Option

vs. TAP / Transition GPS

TAP is a mandatory military product. It covers resume writing, VA basics, and financial literacy at the shallowest possible level. It's designed to check a box, not to actually prepare you. It doesn't address identity, isolation, relationship communication, mental resilience, entrepreneurship, or long-term purpose. MISSION REBUILD™ covers all of it, in depth, from someone who's lived it.

vs. Generic Online Courses

Most civilian transition courses are built by HR professionals, consultants, or marketers who are translating what they think veterans need. They use corporate language veterans don't respond to. They don't address the emotional and psychological dimensions of transition because that's uncomfortable. They focus on resumes and LinkedIn profiles and miss the root problem entirely. MISSION REBUILD™ was built by a veteran who crashed and rebuilt — the curriculum comes from lived experience, not research.

vs. VSO Programs and Nonprofit Resources

Veterans service organizations do important work. They also tend to be bureaucratic, underfunded, peer-led with inconsistent quality, and focused on crisis intervention rather than strategic rebuilding. MISSION REBUILD™ is a structured, premium product designed for the veteran who is functional but not flourishing — the population that most nonprofit resources aren't built to serve.

vs. Therapy and Counseling

Therapy is valuable. This course doesn't replace it. MISSION REBUILD™ is not mental health treatment — it's a life strategy course. It addresses emotional dimensions of transition as practical problems to solve, not symptoms to process. Veterans who need clinical support are encouraged to pursue it. This course gives them the strategic and structural foundation alongside that work.

vs. Veteran Coaching Programs

Some veteran coaches do excellent work. MISSION REBUILD™ provides a structured curriculum that produces outcomes in a defined timeframe at a fraction of the cost of 1:1 coaching. The coaching tier of MISSION REBUILD™ adds live support on top of the system — it doesn't replace the system with a person.

The Real Differentiator:

This course tells the truth. It names the alcohol. It names the identity crisis. It names the slow drift. Most veteran transition products are too polished and too careful to say the hard things. MISSION REBUILD™ is written by someone who went through the hard things and is willing to say them plainly. That authenticity is not a brand choice — it's a survival requirement for a product trying to reach veterans who can smell inauthenticity from three rooms away.

Pricing Recommendations

Tier 1 — MISSION REBUILD™ Self-Paced: \$297

What's included:

- Full 12-week video curriculum (all 13 modules)
- All module workbooks (PDF, printable)
- Mid-course and final project templates
- Access to the MISSION REBUILD™ private community (90-day access from enrollment)
- All bonus resources (VA benefits reference, financial tools guide, recommended reading)
- Lifetime access to the course materials (no expiration)

Why \$297:

This is the accessible entry point. At \$297, a veteran using the GI Bill housing allowance or any part-time income can participate. It's low enough to be a serious-but-not-anxiety-inducing purchase decision, and high enough to signal that this is a real product with real value, not a free PDF with a paywall in front of it. Veterans who self-select into a \$297 course are motivated enough to show up. It's not so cheap that it attracts people who won't do the work.

Psychological framing for sales: Less than one month of cable + streaming. Less than what most veterans spend on alcohol, supplements, or gear in a month. One year of GI Bill housing allowance can easily absorb this. The investment is trivially small relative to the outcome.

Tier 2 — MISSION REBUILD™ With Coaching: \$697

What's included:

- Everything in Tier 1
- 4 live group coaching calls (one per month over the 12-week program, 60–90 minutes each) with the course creator
- Call recordings available for 12 months
- Priority access in the community forum — questions get answered within 24 hours
- Mid-course project feedback (written, from the creator or a trained facilitator)
- Final project review and feedback session (30-minute 1:1 video call)

Why \$697:

The jump from \$297 to \$697 is \$400. That \$400 buys direct access to the creator, structured accountability, and feedback on the most important deliverables in the course. For veterans who have the money and know they need accountability — or who have struggled to self-direct in the past — this tier is an obvious upgrade. The 4 group calls alone, priced at a conservative \$100/session, justify the price difference. The 1:1 final review pushes it well past the value threshold.

Who should buy this tier: Veterans who know they need accountability. Veterans who are farther out from service and have been drifting. Veterans who want direct feedback from someone who's lived the experience, not just content to consume. Veterans who have tried to rebuild before and lost momentum.

Tier 3 — MISSION REBUILD™ Mastermind: \$1,497

What's included:

- Everything in Tiers 1 and 2
- Monthly 1:1 coaching call with the creator (12 months)
- Private Mastermind community — small group (max 15 veterans per cohort) with high accountability norms
- Real-time feedback on business ideas, career moves, financial decisions, and major life choices during the program
- Exclusive quarterly calls with guest experts (financial advisors who specialize in veterans, hiring managers, veteran entrepreneurs)
- First access to future MISSION REBUILD™ products, advanced modules, and alumni programming
- Annual cohort retreat (when available — in-person or virtual)
- Done-with-you VA benefits navigation support (not legal advice; practical guidance through the system)
- Optional anonymous case study participation: have your story documented and used in course marketing, with potential revenue share for affiliate referrals

Why \$1,497:

The Mastermind is not for everyone and shouldn't be positioned as if it is. It's for the veteran who is serious enough to make a significant financial commitment, who wants the accountability of a small group with shared skin in the game, and who wants direct access to the creator at a level that a group coaching call can't provide. At \$1,497, this is still dramatically less expensive than private coaching (\$5,000+ for a comparable engagement) while providing more structure and a peer network. The 15-person cohort cap creates real scarcity and genuine accountability. Veterans in the Mastermind have social pressure from peers who are watching — which is the closest thing to the unit accountability structure that drove performance in the Army.

Who should buy this tier: Veterans with a business idea they're ready to move on, veterans navigating significant career transitions (leaving a corporate job, starting a business, pursuing a major investment), veterans who want a peer group with real accountability norms rather than a passive community, and veterans who are ready to stop dabbling and start executing.

Course Format

Core Delivery Mechanism

Video Lessons

Each module is delivered primarily through video. Lessons are recorded in a direct, unscripted (or lightly scripted) format that sounds like a real conversation. No teleprompter stiffness. No over-produced studio feel. The creator talks like a veteran talking to a veteran — which means directly, without filler, occasionally bluntly, occasionally with dark humor, always with the assumption that the student can handle the truth.

Lesson length targets:

- Module overview/intro: 5–10 minutes
- Core concept lessons: 10–20 minutes each
- Practical application lessons: 15–25 minutes each
- Total per module: 30–90 minutes of video content

Module Workbooks (PDF)

Every module has a companion workbook. These are not note-taking templates — they are thinking tools. They contain:

- Key concept summaries (so the video can be the conversation, not the textbook)
- Reflection prompts (specific, not generic — "What did you use alcohol to manage this week?" not "How are you feeling?")
- Action planning frameworks (step-by-step formats for each assignment)
- Progress tracking for multi-week habits and commitments
- Space for handwritten notes (the workbooks are designed to be printed, not filled out digitally)

Community Platform

The MISSION REBUILD™ community exists on a private platform (Circle, Mighty Networks, or Discord — TBD based on audience age and preference). Each module has its own dedicated channel. Community norms are strict:

- No venting without a request for input
- No toxic positivity ("you've got this, brother!")
- Accountability posts are required, not encouraged
- Anonymity is protected; nobody has to reveal more than they choose to
- The creator participates actively, especially in the first 90 days of each cohort

Live Q&A Calls (Tier 2 and 3)

Monthly live group calls on Zoom. These are not lectures — they're office hours with structure. Each call has a brief topical focus (matching the current module) followed by open Q&A. Calls are recorded and posted within 24 hours for anyone who missed them live.

Premium Offer Stack

What's Included at Every Tier

Bonus 1: The Veteran Benefits Decoder (Standalone Value: \$97)

A practical, plain-language walkthrough of VA benefits — disability ratings and the claims process, education benefits (GI Bill comparison, BAH rates, Vocational Rehabilitation), home loan benefits, healthcare, SGLI conversion and life insurance decisions, and where to go when the system isn't working. This is not a legal document. It's a field guide written by someone who navigated the system late and is helping others do it sooner.

Bonus 2: The Veteran Financial Baseline Workbook (Standalone Value: \$47)

A financial snapshot tool designed specifically for transitioning veterans. It walks through income, expenses, debts, VA benefits income potential, GI Bill BAH calculation, and the basic math of financial breathing room. Includes a simple investment primer (Roth IRA, TSP rollover, index fund basics) that doesn't assume any existing financial knowledge.

Bonus 3: The Civilian Translation Framework (Standalone Value: \$47)

A guided framework for translating military experience into civilian language — for resumes, for interviews, for networking. Includes before/after examples from multiple MOSs, a list of high-value civilian equivalents for common military roles, and a 30-second professional narrative template.

Bonus 4: The Recommended Reading Stack

A curated list of books organized by module topic — not a generic self-help reading list. Books veterans have actually found useful, annotated with why they're valuable and in what order to read them.

Tier 2 and 3 Exclusive Bonuses

Bonus 5: The VA Claims Roadmap (Tier 2+)

A step-by-step guide to filing an initial disability claim or supplemental claim, including what to document, how to get buddy statements, and how to respond to a rating that's lower than expected. Written from personal experience, not from the VA's perspective.

Bonus 6: House Hacking 101 for Veterans (Tier 2+)

A primer on using the VA home loan as a house hacking vehicle — buying a multi-unit property, living in one unit, and renting the others to cover or eliminate the mortgage. Covers VA loan eligibility, multi-unit property rules, basic landlord considerations, and the math of why this is one of the best financial moves

available to veterans in today's market.

Bonus 7: The Entrepreneurship Decision Checklist (Tier 3 only)

A brutally honest framework for evaluating whether a business idea is ready to pursue — or whether it's an escape fantasy. Covers idea validation, minimum viable product thinking, first-customer acquisition, and the specific financial questions that determine whether you can afford to start.

Brand Voice Guide

The Core Voice: Older Brother / Operator Energy

The person behind MISSION REBUILD™ has been there. Not "in general" — specifically there. The voice is the voice of someone who struggled, who didn't have this map, who built it the hard way, and who is now handing it over. That shapes everything. It's not the voice of an expert looking down. It's the voice of someone a few steps ahead on the same path, looking back.

Rule 1: Be Specific, Not Inspirational

Veterans have been inspired at them their entire careers. Motivational speeches, command messages, re-enlistment ceremonies. They're immune to it. Specificity is the antidote to skepticism.

DON'T SAY: "You have everything it takes to succeed in this next chapter."

DO SAY: "By Week 3, you'll have a written monthly budget, your VA benefits mapped, and a savings target with a specific number attached to it. That's not inspiration — that's a financial position."

Rule 2: Name the Hard Things

The hard things — alcohol, identity crisis, the slow drift, relationship damage — are not topics to avoid in marketing or in content. They are the topics that make a veteran lean forward and think "*this person actually knows what's happening to me.*" Naming the hard things is the single most trust-building thing you can do.

DON'T SAY: "Many veterans struggle with the adjustment period after service."

DO SAY: "If you're having three, four drinks most nights and telling yourself it's fine — it's not an emergency, but it's also not fine. We're going to talk about what that's actually managing for you, and what

to do instead."

Rule 3: Assign Agency, Not Blame

Veterans don't respond to being told they're victims of the military, the VA, the civilian world, or their upbringing. They also don't respond to being told everything is their fault. The voice navigates this by assigning responsibility without blame: the system failed you AND your response to it is now your responsibility. Both things are true.

DON'T SAY: "The military prepared you poorly and left you without the tools you needed." (Too victimizing)

DON'T SAY: "Everything that happened since you got out is your responsibility." (Too blaming)

DO SAY: "The transition prep you got was inadequate. That's a fact. What you do about it right now is entirely yours. This course is that option."

Rule 4: No Corporate HR Language

Words like "stakeholders," "alignment," "synergy," "best practices," "emotional intelligence," "ecosystem," and "professional development journey" are banned. Not just discouraged — banned. Veterans hear this language and check out. If you can't say it in plain English, say it in plain English.

DON'T SAY: "This module will help you leverage your core competencies to align with civilian professional ecosystems."

DO SAY: "This module is about figuring out what you're actually good at, how to say it in a way civilians understand, and where to find jobs where that matters."

Rule 5: Respect the Intelligence of the Audience

Veterans are not simple people who need things oversimplified. They operated weapons systems, managed logistics chains, led people under life-and-death pressure, navigated bureaucracies, and made consequential decisions in chaotic environments. Talk to them like that's true.

DON'T SAY: "Budgeting might sound complicated, but it's really just keeping track of your money!"

DO SAY: "You ran supply logistics under fire. Basic personal finance is not a complex problem. The reason most veterans don't have their finances together isn't capability — it's that nobody ever gave them

a system. Here's the system."

Rule 6: Earn the Emotional Moments

This course deals with emotionally heavy material — identity, loss, isolation, relationship damage. The voice doesn't flinch from that. But it also doesn't lead with it. Earn the emotional moments by establishing credibility and utility first. By the time you say something vulnerable, the student trusts you enough for it to land.

DON'T SAY: (In your first video) "I want to share how lost I felt after getting out."

DO SAY: (After two weeks of useful, practical content) "I want to tell you something that took me a while to admit. The first 18 months after I got out, I was drinking about a fifth a week and calling it 'decompressing.' Nobody was going to say anything to me because I was still functioning. I'm saying it now because you should be able to name it to yourself, whatever it is for you."

Rule 7: Use Humor Correctly

Military humor is dark, self-deprecating, and specific. It's a release valve. Appropriate use of that humor builds connection and breaks tension at the right moments. Inappropriate use of humor undermines trust at serious moments. The rule: dark humor on logistics, bureaucracy, and civilian absurdities — yes. Dark humor on identity crisis, relationship damage, or mental health — only when it's self-directed and earned.

APPROPRIATE: "The VA appointment system makes Army in-processing look efficient. And you've been through Army in-processing."

NOT APPROPRIATE: "Ha, yeah, the whole 'who am I without the Army' thing — classic, right? Anyway, let's talk about resumes."

Rule 8: Close Loops, Don't Pump Up

The temptation at the end of every lesson or module is to motivate — to send the student out with a "you've got this!" energy. Resist it. Veterans don't need the pump-up. They need to know what comes next. Close with specificity: here's what you just covered, here's what you're going to do, here's what the next module addresses.

DON'T SAY: "You're doing great work and I'm proud of you for being here. Let's keep pushing!"

DO SAY: "You just mapped your identity foundations and named the gap between who you were in the Army and who you're building now. The assignment this week is in the workbook — do it before you hit Module 2. We're moving next into structure and discipline, because identity without a daily operating system is just philosophy."

This document is an internal strategy reference. Do not publish as-is. Use as the foundation for all marketing copy, course scripts, sales page development, and team onboarding.